



Counting Happiness

BSG Statistics Department Monthly Newsletter



KOSEN-RUFU

Our Shared Vow



ABACUS Editorial



RESPONDING TO OUR MENTOR WITH A SHARED VOW TO ADVANCE KOSEN- RUFU

Dear Mathematicians of Happiness,

First of all, many thanks and sincere gratitude for all the hard work that you are doing and the even greater efforts you will make in this year of Vibrant Growth for a Youthful Soka

Gakkai Worldwide. Due to all your sincere efforts, BSG continues to advance with members experiencing victories after victories while joyfully struggling for kosen-rufu.

The month of February is upon

us. Traditionally this month is known as the month of propagation. Be it Kamata campaign, Yamaguchi campaign, or Sapporo campaign, Ikeda Sensei opened new paths for kosen-rufu, achieving victory and glory for his mentor, Toda Sensei. All his actions were based on one thing - "I am Toda Sensei's direct disciple".

What was the main cause behind the historic victories in these campaigns? It was because Ikeda Sensei's heart was one with Toda Sensei and he considered the cherished goal of 7,50,000 households as his personal goal to be achieved for his mentor. Ikeda Sensei writes, "Buddhism is about winning, so defeat is unacceptable. If I fail, Mr Toda's vision for kosen-rufu will suffer a setback. I must not be defeated; I must be able to report victory to him" (Making the Impossible Possible, p. 4).

This month also marks the 65th anniversary of Ikeda Sensei's first visit to India in 1961. Through

his profound determination, all of us have emerged as Bodhisattvas of the Earth and as Shinichi Yamamotos of a New Age India who will accomplish Sensei's vision of worldwide kosen-rufu and goal of one million happy BSG members by 2030.

At present, with **area-wise May 3rd campaigns being introduced across BSG**, we are once again standing at a decisive moment. These campaigns provide a powerful opportunity for statistics incharges to support leaders and members by ensuring accurate data - so that every member and friend is reached, encouraged, and able to participate meaningfully. Strong statistics will build strong units.

So, let's all of us as statistics incharges of BSG respond to Ikeda Sensei by doing our best, working hardest in our respective areas-ensuring that our respective areas vision for 2026 and membership target is surely achieved.

- By ABACUS Editorial Team ★★

BSG STATISTICS DEPARTMENT MOTTO

"With the heart of oneness of mentor and disciple, we cherish each life as Bodhisattva of the Earth and strive diligently towards the dynamic and eternal advancement of Kosen-rufu."

ETERNAL GUIDELINE FOR THE STATISTICS DEPARTMENT

"A membership card is not a piece of paper; it is the life of one person. In it, the life pulsates, the personality is contained, and the drama of awakening in faith and rebirth is played out. There exist the human-to-human bonds of warm trust. Because we have been cherishing each person to the utmost, we see the magnificent development of the Soka Gakkai today."

- Daisaku Ikeda (December 15, 2002)

Making my mentor's vow my own

At this inauguration as second Soka Gakkai president, Mr Toda declared: "I will through my own efforts reach the goal of 750,000 member households.... Should I fail to do so, don't hold a funeral for me."

The majority of his disciples at that time, however, dismissed this important declaration — giving voice to the great vow he would devote his life to fulfilling — as little more than a fantasy. The Soka Gakkai's newspaper, the Seikyo Shimbun, didn't even report his statement. Arrogant leaders, thinking that they knew better than their mentor, prevented its publication, not wishing to have an unachievable goal set down in print for posterity.

When Mr Toda became president in May 1951, the monthly propagation goal of even the top chapters was a mere 50 member households. But I realized that the path of a disciple is to make the vision of one's mentor a reality, no matter how challenging it might be. As Mr Toda's disciple, his vow became my vow, and achieving it became my personal mission.

But propagation efforts throughout the organization failed to advance. In fact, in their hearts, everyone had given up. The veteran leaders did nothing but lament and moan about the thick wall that loomed before them and blocked the way to growth.

I, however, saw it as a time ripe for action, and I leapt onto the main battlefield of kosen-rufu as the chapter adviser of Tokyo's Kamata Chapter. This happened in the cold month of February 1952, the month of Mr Toda's 52nd birthday.

I proclaimed Mr Toda's message far and wide. I urged the members to follow the path of mentor and disciple. This is because when we align our hearts with the spirit of our mentor for kosen-rufu, the wisdom and courage innate to the Bodhisattvas of the Earth well forth within us.

Seeking to respond to Mr Toda, the members joined me with renewed determination and set to work courageously. Our efforts brought us joy, hope, adventure, and energy. Everyone eagerly took part. And in one dramatic sweep, Kamata achieved the previously unheard-of goal of 201 new member households in a single month. We realized that if we tried, we could succeed. A decisive breakthrough toward realizing Mr Toda's goal of 750,000 member households had been made. Kamata had triumphed! Great progress toward victory in my hometown of Tokyo had begun.

(Making Impossible Possible, p.1-3) ★★



FROM DATA TO DETERMINATION: RESPONDING THROUGH STATISTICS

Ayushi Jain

**Chapter Statistics Incharge
Delhi North Area**



Scan to listen to
the experience

I started practicing Nichiren Daishonin's Buddhism in 2020 in Himachal Pradesh. After attending 2 meetings there, I moved to Panipat. Although my transfer had been initiated, my new zone was unaware of it. This delay meant my attendance was not being marked, and my "friend-to-member" status was stalled. Eager to access study material on the Trailblazer portal, I followed up persistently with my leaders. This experience shifted my perspective on statistics and sparked a deep curiosity about how accurate data influences our kosen-rufu movement.

In 2021, I took on responsibility as district statistics incharge (DSI). The previous DSI shared the spirit behind the numbers and guided me through MDS. Ikeda Sensei says, **"Your duty in managing statistics is like facilitating the smooth flow of blood in the human body. If the flow stagnates, the body dies. Therefore, the importance of your mission is immeasurable"** (VC, Jan 2007, p. 155). While organising block level activities, I discovered many members were incorrectly placed in blocks and unable to connect locally.

I immediately began calling them to update addresses. We cleared pending introductions and ensured new members were contacted without delay.

Post-COVID, attendance and VC subscriptions dropped significantly, and many leaders and members became inactive. Whenever active members fondly mentioned someone, they had practised with, I searched the statistics and reached out to them. We created division and block wise google sheets so every leader could access information instantly. At that time, the Future Division (FD) was inactive in Panipat. However, while updating records, we realized we had enough FD members to start with FD activities. Soon, the highlight of our discussion meetings became FD activities, filling our districts with joy.

Also, there were no Gohonzon conferrals done in the district post COVID which I resolved to change. I encouraged members to apply and facilitated Gohonzon applications. As a result, we could do seven Gohonzon conferrals in 2024 in Panipat for the first time.

Later in the same year, I took responsibility for chapter statistics. Many members who joined post-COVID had never experienced in-person contribution activity. Along with the DSIs, I reviewed the BDS to update missing email IDs. We didn't just invite members – we ensured the entire contribution process was seamless, whether from home or at the venue. Chapter leaders reviewed training videos thoroughly so the process would run smoothly even in my absence.

For the registration of intermediate exam, we helped members to

download the BSG Connect Plus app and register. I used every opportunity such as travelling with members for meetings to encourage them to apply. As a result, nearly every eligible member applied.

In our chapter, we have not missed marking attendance for a single discussion meeting. For any district pending, I work with the DSIs to mark it before freezing. This gives us an opportunity to revisit our determination as statistics incharge. Today, both DSIs treat marking attendance as a personal responsibility. Also, the VC subscriptions in the chapter have increased, members are doing home visits enthusiastically and are determined to fight for kosen-rufu.

Fighting as a statistics incharge, I have received many benefits. Despite deep financial challenges, our family has grown closer, happier, and more harmonious. My brother overcame severe bullying, my father has started chanting and regained hope, and my mother emerged from depression into her most vibrant self. We have built trust with neighbours and relatives, many of whom now attend meetings. Even my own approach to work and Gakkai activities has shifted from pressure-driven to joy-filled and purposeful.

Toward the goal of one million members by 2030, I am determined to strengthen the statistics in my unit, ensuring that every new friend is embraced and every life is cherished. With lightning-speed responses to introductions and transfers, timely attendance marking, updated members details and facilitating Gohonzon applications, I am determined to respond to Ikeda Sensei. ★★



Timely attendance marking is an expression of reporting victory to Ikeda Sensei by statistics incharges!

Introducing the zones where all the districts marked the '**Discussion Meeting**' attendance in the month of January 2026.

*We accord these zones as '**MATHEMATICIANS OF THE MONTH**' for January 2026.*

MATHEMATICIANS OF THE MONTH

Delhi - East

Ananda - Lotus
Expressway - Jaypee
Ghaziabad
Noida City Centre
Noida West
Sahibabad - Meerut
Shahdara - Anand Vihar

Delhi - North

Central Pitampura
Delhi University
Mansarovar - Naraina
Model Town - Chatrasal
Paschim Vihar - Punjabi Bagh
Pusa
Rohini

East India

Central Kolkata
Dumdum
EM Bypass
Howrah
Odisha North 1
South Central
Tolly Jadavpur - Bihar

North India

Amritsar
Chandigarh
Jaipur Midtown
Jammu
Kanpur
Lucknow
Lucknow - Gorakhpur
Mansarovar
Mohali
Panchkula East
Panchkula West
Rajasthan North

Delhi - South

Badkal - Faridabad
C R Park - Kalkaji
Charmwood
Faridabad
Green Park
Kailash
Malviya Nagar
New Friends Colony
Sainik Farm
Saket
Sarita Vihar

South India

AP - Telangana (North)
Bangalore South
Bangalore South Central
Bangalore South East
Bangalore South West
Chennai Central
Chennai East

Delhi - West

Aravali
DLF 1 & 3
DLF 2 & 4
Dwarka - Palam
Dwarka - Uttam Nagar
Epicentre
Golf Course
Janak Puri
Nirvana
Palam Vihar
SBTG
Shanti Path
Sohna
Vasant Kunj East
Vasant Kunj West
Vikasपुरi

West India - 1

Ahmedabad Central
Baner - Central
Goregaon Malad East
Goregaon Malad West
Koregaon - Airport
Mulund Ghatkopar
Nasik - Aurangabad
PCMC - Aundh
Powai
Pune South 1
Pune South Hills
Surat

West India - 2

Bandra
Chembur - Ghatkopar
Gateway
Goa
Juhu Link - Yari Road
Juhu Vile Parle
Khar Santacruz BKC
Lokhandwala - Oshiwara
Navi Mumbai
Sion Parel
Tardeo Malabar

MEETINGS IN FEBRUARY 2026

22nd February 2026

Discussion Meeting



District Statistics Incharge
to mark the attendance

28th February 2026

Student Division Meeting



Region Statistics Incharge
to mark the attendance

Let's promptly mark the attendance of the above meetings and report victory as statistics incharges!



HAPPINESS COUNTER



BSG

2 9 1 5 7 0



Youth Division

1 4 3 6 9 1

Q. Can we introduce a new friend to a BSG meeting besides discussion meeting?

Yes, if we wish to introduce a guest, we can bring them to a BSG meeting. Their first meeting does not need to be limited to a discussion meeting. It can be any of the following meetings such as *All India Study Meeting, Arts Division Meeting, BSG HQ Gongyo & Tour Meeting, Campus Group Meeting, District Planning Meeting, Education Division Meeting, Healthcare Division Meeting, New Friends Meeting, Student Division Meeting or any other divisional Meeting.*

Q. What should be done after they attend their first BSG meeting?

Once the guest attends a BSG meeting, their details should be immediately shared with the district statistics incharge (DSI) so they can be added in the BDS as a New Friend.

The Spiritual Basis: Respecting Each Life

Ikeda Sensei quotes Nichiren Daishonin's profound guidance to a disciple: **"How could I regard as strangers the people who, if only for a day or even for a**

moment, have helped me survive?No matter what may happen in the future, be assured that I will never forsake or neglect you.” (WND-1, p. 895; VC, May 2016, p. 2-3).

These words reveal the depth of the Daishonin’s spirit – never treating anyone as insignificant, never overlooking even the briefest connection. Even a momentary bond is something to be treasured.

In the same way, when a guest attends a BSG meeting – even for the very first time – that connection is profound. To embrace each life with sincerity and attentiveness is the heart of our practice.

Every guest possesses the life state of Buddhahood. Promptly adding them in the BDS is not merely an administrative task – it is an expression of deep respect, faith and unwavering belief in the highest potential of their life.

As a statistics incharge, this action reflects the spirit of cherishing each new friend as a Bodhisattva of the Earth.

Why Immediate Entry Matters

Timely inclusion in BDS helps the district to:

- Identify and connect with new friends quickly
- Offer support and encouragement without delay
- Introduce them to the basics of faith
- Help them come into rhythm with the soka movement of humanism

Adding them to BDS immediately is both our responsibility and compassion for their care, growth and victory.



ABACUS Editorial Team, in conversation with

Archana Sharma

Region Statistics Incharge, Delhi East Area



Please share your journey of being a statistics incharge?

I started practising Nichiren Buddhism in 1998 as a YWD. In 2014, while serving as a WD district chief, I was assigned the responsibility of district statistics incharge. At that time, we were using MDS. Since I had a good grasp of computers, I joyfully accepted this responsibility determined to imbibe the spirit of the Statistics Department – that *each number in MDS represents a precious life*.

From the very beginning, I made it a practice to generate reports, share them with block chiefs, and discuss concrete home-visitation

plans. Together, we focused on caring for new friends, and inactive members. Chanting together, encouraging members through Sensei's guidance, teaching Gongyo and Daimoku to new friends, and supporting members to attend and actively participate in meetings gradually became a strong rhythm in my daily life.

Later, when I assumed the responsibility of chapter statistics incharge, the BDS was introduced. Initially, I faced a few challenges, but with prayer and efforts, I soon gained confidence in handling the system. Currently, I am taking care of region statistics for the Noida Zodiac region with deep gratitude and a strong sense of mission.



How has being a statistics incharge helped you personally?

When I became chapter statistics incharge, one of my biggest challenges was ensuring that meeting attendance was marked promptly. Personally, I had hesitation in giving reminders to district statistics incharges. However, through earnest daimoku and a firm determination to respond to Sensei with swift communication, I began building bonds of trust and friendship with the district statistics incharges (DSIs).

Together, we chanted to elevate our life condition and proactively reached out to new friends, inactive members, and respond to transfers. By regularly reviewing BDS reports, I learnt about several Gohonzon members who had drifted away from practice and reached out to them.

Over the past two years, I have been able to help revive three Gohonzon members and many inactive members. Each such victory has deepened my conviction in the Gohonzon and strengthened my resolve to advance kosen-rufu as a disciple of Sensei.

The statistics responsibility has trained me to take swift and decisive action in both my personal and professional life.



Please share your experience of working on BDS?

BDS is a comprehensive system that provides transparency, clarity, and encouragement through its dashboard. At times, I have experienced data-synchronization issues, particularly related to VC subscriptions.

There were some initial challenges during the launch of new features and the system updates. However, despite these hiccups, my priority has always been timely action and sincere member care. With the spirit of putting members first, BDS continues to be an invaluable tool in my efforts to advance kosen-rufu.



Do you read the ABACUS regularly? What do you think is the importance of ABACUS personally for you?

I read ABACUS regularly, with only a few occasional misses. I strongly feel that for all statistics incharges, ABACUS is an essential source of inspiration. It helps us understand Sensei's heart and spirit for member care.

The more deeply we understand this spirit, the more effectively we can use BDS. For me, BDS is a means to embrace every life through daimoku, and take responsibility for strengthening my bond, as well as each member's bond with the Gohonzon and Sensei.



What is your determination as statistics incharge towards 2030?

With the BSG goal of achieving one million members by 2030, I am determined to challenge myself in shakubuku, winning over my hesitation in initiating dialogues.

I am also determined to ensure more planned, consistent, and compassionate care for new friends joining the practice. With daimoku, unity, and unwavering faith, I will contribute wholeheartedly toward this great mission. ★★



Rearrange the jumbled phrases to form the original guidance by Ikeda Sensei. Take your time and enjoy the process.

HINT – All the guidance comes from President Ikeda's words of encouragement in 'Day by Day and Month after Month' published in value creation each month.

1. And the essence of life/ we can become even happier/ because we have problems/ this is the heart of faith/ by facing our struggles head-on/ we can become happy.
2. And win without fail/ a heart filled with gratitude/ when we dedicate our lives to the path of mentor and disciple,/ is strong, profound, and rich/ in all our endeavors/ we can bring forth limitless power, break through our limitations.
3. We uplift our own hearts, too/ words spoken from the heart will resonate with others/ a person can know another's mind by listening to the voice/ when we sincerely reach out and talk with our friends.
4. To attain Buddhahood/ our Buddhist practice is not an obligation/ our own determination and efforts in faith/ but a right that enables us/ we will gain benefit in direct proportion to.
5. Win each day!/ and Buddhism is win or lose/ advance each day!/ after all, not advancing is retreating,/ this is the Gakkai way of life.
6. We will win in all areas of our lives/ when we win in the morning,/ is key to getting the most out of each day/ it's a win for the entire day/ starting the morning off right/ if we make this a habit.
7. And open the way to making the impossible possible/ no matter what obstacles lie ahead,/ to bring forth immeasurable wisdom/ keep chanting earnestly/ doing so will allow you/ and boldly take a step forward.

Please send your answers at statistics@bharatsokagakkai.org by 28th February 2026

LAST MONTH'S PUZZLE WINNERS

★ Arpit Jariwala – West India 1

★ Sonia Jhington – West India 1

★ Kailash Gajare – West India 1

★ Tapati Mukherjee – East India

★ Shobha Dube – Delhi North

ANSWERS OF LAST MONTH'S PUZZLE

1. won, accurate	5. hard work, support others
2. Buddha, happiness	6. defeat
3. shakubuku	7. difficult
4. irreplaceable	8. cherish, encourage



BDS HELPDESK

In case of any query or assistance on BDS, please write to: helpdesk@bharatsokagakkai.org or create a ticket on BDS under 'Ticket System'.

WE WANT YOUR FEEDBACK

We look forward to hearing from you! Please write to us if you have any feedback on the newsletter or if you wish to share your experience as statistics incharge; please mail us at : statistics@bharatsokagakkai.org

